

Assignment Brief: Hoisting Safety, Manual Transfer Techniques, and Ergonomics in Care Settings

Course/Module: Digital System

Assessment Weight: 100 Marks (100% of Assignment Grade)

Format: ShortEssay/Critical Responses

Expected Length: 300–450 words per question (3,000–4,500 words total)

Instructions to Students

This assignment requires you to critically evaluate contemporary frameworks in institutional care, ethics, law, and quality improvement. While these themes may have been introduced in course webinars, **every response must be grounded in independent external research.**

You must cite external literature, legal statutes, sociological concepts, or comparative international frameworks as specified in each prompt. Ensure all sources are correctly cited using the required academic referencing style (e.g., APA 7th Edition).

Question 1:

Before executing a patient transfer, what key ergonomic factors and resident mobility indicators must a care worker evaluate in a risk management template to determine whether a manual transfer is safe or requires mechanical assistance?

Question 2:

Explain the correct mechanical principles and body positioning required when using slide sheets to reposition a resident in bed. How do slide sheets reduce friction and shearing forces on both the resident's skin and the care worker's spine?

Question 3:

Under what specific physical conditions is it appropriate to use a transfer belt (gait belt) to assist a resident with standing or walking, and what are the clinical contraindications where a transfer belt must never be used?

Question 4:

Prior to operating a mobile or ceiling-mounted mechanical hoist, what essential pre-use equipment checks must be performed on the hoisting unit, lifting arm, emergency stop controls, and battery/hydraulic systems?

Question 5:

How does a care worker determine the correct sling size, model, and weight capacity for an individual resident, and what specific signs of fabric wear, stitching fraying, or clip damage would require a sling to be immediately retired from service?

Question 6:

Being lifted in a mechanical hoist can cause distress or anxiety for residents. What communication techniques and preparation steps should care workers use before and during a hoist transfer to maintain resident dignity and reassure them throughout the process?

Question 7:

Why do standard workplace health and safety (WHS) policies require two trained staff members to conduct a mechanical hoist transfer? What are the specific individual roles and safety responsibilities of the primary operator and the secondary assistant during the maneuver?

Question 8:

What are the primary biomechanical factors that lead to back injuries and soft-tissue strain among care workers during manual transfers, and how do proper base-of-support posture, core stabilization, and avoiding spinal twisting mitigate worker injury?

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Question 9:

If an electronic mechanical hoist experiences a power cutoff or system malfunction while a resident is suspended mid-transfer, what immediate steps and manual emergency lowering procedures must care staff follow to safely lower the resident?

Question 10:

If a resident's mobility unexpectedly declines during a transfer attempt, what documentation must be updated in their care plan and risk assessment logs, and how should this change be communicated to the broader care team?

Marking Scheme & Grading Rubric (100 Marks Total)

Each of the 10 questions is worth **10 marks**, assessed against the following criteria:

High Distinction	9 - 10	Exceptional synthesis of external research. Argument is highly critical, nuanced, and perfectly directly addresses all parts of the prompt. Flawless referencing.
Distinction	7.5 - 8.5	Strong integration of external concepts. Solid analysis with clear logical flow. Minor gaps in depth or minor formatting issues.
Credit	6 - 7	Adequate research, though relies on basic definitions. Analysis is present but lacks critical depth or systemic insight. Competent writing and referencing.
Pass	5 - 5.5	Barely addresses the prompt. Heavy reliance on course materials rather than independent external research. Descriptive rather than analytical.
Fail	0 - 4.5	Fails to answer the prompt. Missing external research entirely. Poorly structured, lacking citations, or demonstrating fundamental misunderstandings of the topic.